



Meta heavily courted China

Whistleblower says tech giant mulled censorship, sharing user data

BY NAOMI NIX

Meta was willing to go to extreme lengths to censor content and shut down political dissent in a failed attempt to win the approval of the Chinese Communist Party and bring Facebook to millions of internet users in China, according to a new whistleblower complaint from a former global policy director at the company.

The complaint by Sarah Wynn-Williams, who worked on a team handling China policy, alleges that the social media giant so desperately wanted to enter the lucrative China market that it was willing to allow the ruling party to oversee all social media content appearing in the country and quash dissenting opinions.

Meta, then called Facebook, developed a censorship system for China in 2015 and planned to install a “chief editor” who would decide what content to remove and could shut down the entire site during times of “social unrest,” according to a copy of the 78-page complaint exclusively seen by The Washington Post.

Meta chief executive Mark Zuckerberg also agreed to crack down on the account of a high-profile Chinese dissident living in the United States following pressure from a high-ranking Chinese official the company hoped would help them enter China, according to the complaint, which was filed in April to the Securities and Exchange Commission.

When asked about its efforts to enter China, Meta executives repeatedly “stonewalled and provided nonresponsive or misleading information” to investors and American regulators, according

SEE META ON A9



PHOTOS BY KAYLEE GREENLEE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Potential Medicaid cuts could sever lifeline provided by rural hospitals

As GOP weighs budget bill, some health services and party’s power in such areas may suffer

BY LAUREN WEBER

HONDO, TEXAS — Jaylee Williams needed to find somewhere to deliver her son.

The 19-year-old knew more about barrel racing on her horse Bet-n-pep than the complicated metrics of who takes what health insurance. But relief for Williams and her boyfriend, Xander Lopez, came when they realized Medina Regional Hospital — just 15 minutes from their home — accepted Medicaid, the federal-state program that covers medical costs for lower-income Americans. Provider groups an hour away in San Antonio had refused to take the insurance, she recalled while cradling little Ryker.



TOP: Laura Hansen attends to patients at Medina Regional Hospital in Hondo, Texas. ABOVE: Vivian with her mother, Chelsea Sullaway, at a 37-week pregnancy checkup.

“You never know when something could happen,” Williams said, with Lopez adding, “I have no idea where we would have gone” without Medina Regional Hospital.

But the lifeline that the 25-bed critical-access hospital offered to Williams and Lopez could disappear in Hondo and other communities like it.

Rural hospitals across the United States fear that massive Medicaid cuts Republicans would have to consider under the current House budget proposal could decimate maternity services or shutter already struggling medical facilities in communities that overwhelmingly voted for Donald Trump.

SEE MEDICAID ON A6

Anger at Musk turns violent at Tesla lots

BY PRANSHU VERMA AND TRISHA THADANI

The woman in the black hoodie walked onto the Tesla car lot prepared to inflict damage. She came with four Smirnoff Ice bottles filled with gasoline, flung them at electric vehicles parked around the dealership and watched as they burned.

Over the course of 13 days starting Jan. 29, according to court records, Lucy Grace Nelson made repeated trips to the Tesla car lot in Loveland, Colorado. Once, she spray-painted “Nazi” in black under the dealership’s entrance sign, according to court documents, and another time, she ignited a molotov cocktail near a Tesla Cybertruck. She also allegedly used red spray-paint to scribble a message on the car dealership’s entrance doors: “F--- Musk.” Nelson’s lawyer declined to comment on the case.

Since President Donald Trump’s inauguration, more than a dozen violent or destructive acts have been directed at Tesla facilities, according to

SEE TESLA ON A14



MICHAEL S. WILLIAMSON/THE WASHINGTON POST

Democratic Reps. Terri A. Sewell, Hakeem Jeffries and Maxine Waters join civil rights leaders Al Sharpton and Jesse L. Jackson during the Bloody Sunday anniversary march in Selma, Alabama.

At Selma march, fear over civil rights

BY HOLLY BAILEY

SELMA, ALA. — Florence Richardson knows all too well the grim story of Bloody Sunday.

She was there on the Edmund Pettus Bridge 60 years ago and recalls it as vividly as if it were yesterday — the screams of her fellow civil rights marchers as they were attacked by police, the

smell of tear gas and the sound of a galloping horse on her heels ridden by a billy-club-wielding officer who sought to beat her into submission or worse.

“I remember trying to get back across the bridge and looking down at the water below and wondering if I was going to have to jump,” recalled Richardson, who was 23 at the time. “I

thought I was going to die. I thought we all were. ... It was a horrible, horrible day.”

Richardson, now 83 and a lifelong resident of Selma, has almost every year joined the annual walk across the Pettus Bridge to mark the March 7, 1965, attack, one of the more shocking moments of the civil rights era

SEE SELMA ON A7

President retrenches on priorities after backlash

BY JEFF STEIN AND DAN DIAMOND

President Donald Trump on Tuesday night touted his administration’s early work in a prime-time speech to Congress, especially on two of his top priorities: tariffs to transform the global trade order and the work of the U.S. DOGE Service to cut spending at home.

By Thursday, Trump had watered down tariffs on Mexico and Canada that took effect only hours before the speech, scaling back plans for economic transformation in the face of slumping stock markets worldwide. The same day, he also put new limits on DOGE, telling his Cabinet secretaries at a closed-door meeting that they — not billionaire adviser

Elon Musk and his team — had control over which workers their agencies fire.

The moves represent the latest abrupt shifts by a president whose political career has been marked by sudden reversals. They also reflect how Trump is not immune to political, economic or diplomatic pressure, even at the height of his power — with Republican control over Congress, a conservative judiciary and a far more compliant Cabinet than in his first term. As Trump intensifies his efforts to remake the U.S. government, overhaul the systems that regulate trade and international relations and even expand U.S. territory, he’s running into new sources of opposition.

SEE TRUMP ON A5



JASON FRANSON/CANADIAN PRESS/AP

Carney wins election to lead Canada

Former central banker Mark Carney is set to replace Prime Minister Justin Trudeau after his landslide victory on Sunday. The Liberal Party leader ran as a political outsider able to deftly navigate a trade war. **Story, A9**

IN THE NEWS

Protest leader arrested A Palestinian graduate student at Columbia University was detained by Homeland Security agents and told his student visa had been revoked. **A2**

Violence in Syria Hundreds of members of the country’s Alawite minority were reported killed in apparent sectarian bloodletting. **A10**

THE NATION
The Department of Homeland Security named Todd Lyons as acting ICE director. **A3**
The Trump administration said it was pulling out of a pair of global climate programs. **A4**

THE WORLD
Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum has stood strong in talks with Donald Trump. **A8**
Israel will open an office to manage the mass displacement of Palestinians from Gaza. **A10**

THE ECONOMY
Experts warned that Trump administration cuts to a key NOAA agency will endanger U.S. leadership in outer space. **A11**

THE REGION
A pair of eagles at the National Arboretum are expecting at least one hatchling soon. **B1**

An inquiry found that there were “serious issues” in the rollout of a plan to arm some George Washington University police in 2023. **B1**
Metro plans to cut its DEI and sustainability offices ahead of potential executive orders from Trump. **B1**

STYLE
An elite private club opened in downtown Washington with an eye on attracting a who’s who of the city’s power brokers. **C1**
Vice President JD Vance has seen his face contorted and distorted on social media as the subject of memes. **C1**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A11
COMICS.....C7
OBITUARIES.....B4
OPINION PAGES.....A12
TELEVISION.....C6
WORLD NEWS.....A8

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54151

